



MACHINE: Parag Joshi

Using master slides in PowerPoint, you can increase your efficiency and speed of work

Microsoft PowerPoint is the most widely used presentation software by both professionals and students. The main problem faced while creating presentations is maintaining the overall consistency and appeal. Formatting each slide requires too much time and effort, especially when a change has to be made which is presentation-wide—such as changing fonts or adding an image to the background. These problems can be easily overcome by using a very powerful feature of PowerPoint, master slides.

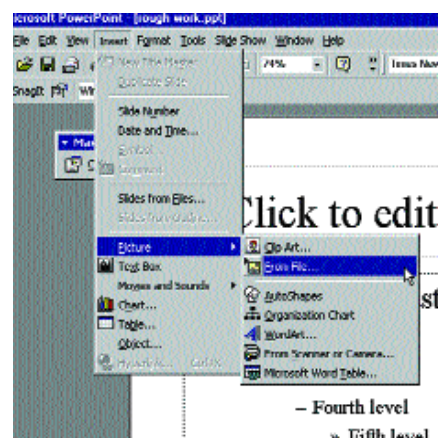
Master slides save time and make it easier for you to achieve consistency in your presentations. They are special slides that define the formatting of the remaining slides in a presentation. For example, if you want a specific formatting style or picture—such as your company logo—to be the background picture for all slides, you can use master slides to achieve this. A master slide also contains placeholders for footers, so whenever you want to insert a footnote in

your slide show, you can just put it on the master slide. Similarly, if you change the formatting of the text in master slide, all the slides of your presentation will reflect that change.

There are also masters to control various other components of a presentation, such as the Title Master, Handout Master and Notes Master. The Title master defines the look of slides that use the title slide layout. The Handout master guides the look of the handouts that you print, and the Notes master changes the way the printed notes look.

Using an image as background

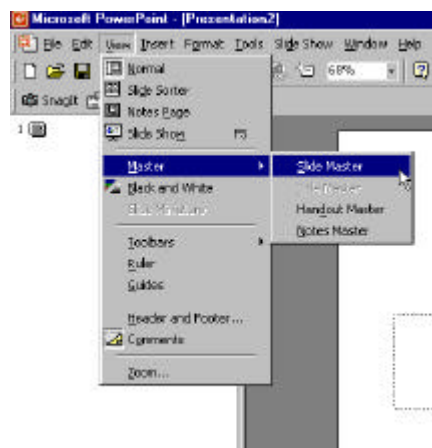
You can create a customised background for your presentation using images such as a picture, or a wallpaper of your choice. This will bring about individuality and



Any image can be used as background for your slides, such as your company logo

consistency to your presentation. To do this, you will need to switch views to Master View. Go to **View > Master > Slide Master**. In order to insert an image as a slide's background, go to **Insert > Image > From File**. Choose the file you want to use as the background and click OK. You may have to resize the image and send it to the back by right-clicking on the image and choosing **Order > Send to back**. You can also do this before switching to Master View, by right-clicking on a slide and choosing **Background**. From the drop down list choose 'Fill Effects...'. Now, click on the **Picture** tab and click on **Select Picture**, choose the picture you want as your background, click **Insert**, then click **OK** and finally click on 'Apply to All'.

Master slides are also useful for placing logos and items that are not necessar-



Switch to Slide Master view to edit the Slide Master

The default .ppt format is good when you are designing presentations, but when you are distributing presentations, it is better to save in the PowerPoint Show (.pps) format, as these files can only be viewed as slide shows but cannot be edited. To save a file in PowerPoint Show format, click **File > Save As** and choose PowerPoint Show (*.pps), and click OK.

